

# ENGLISH LANGUAGE

## (ENGLISH PAPER – 1)

***Maximum Marks: 80***

***Time allowed: Two hours***

1. *Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.*
  2. *You will **not** be allowed to write during the first **15** minutes.*
  3. *This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.*
  4. *The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.*
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5. *Attempt **all five** questions.*
  6. *The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [ ].*
  7. *You are advised to spend not more than **30** minutes in answering **Question 1** and **20** minutes in answering **Question 2**.*

### ***Instruction for the Supervising Examiner***

*Kindly read aloud the Instructions given above to all the candidates present in the Examination Hall.*

**This paper consists of 11 printed pages.**

### Question 1

*(Do not spend more than 30 minutes on this question.)*

Write a composition (300 - 350 words) on **any one** of the following:

[20]

- (i) Write an original short story where a misunderstanding leads to an unexpected friendship.
- (ii) You had to give up something you loved so that someone else could be happy. Write about the incident that led to this, what you felt during that time, and how the experience altered your way of looking at things.
- (iii) Describe a quiet evening spent at home. Explain how it was different and what you gained from the experience.
- (iv) *'Co-curricular activities are as important as academics.'*  
Express your views either **for** or **against** this statement.
- (v) Study the picture given below. Write a story, a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture, or you may take suggestions from it. However, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



## Question 2

(Do not spend more than **20** minutes on this question.)

Select **any one** of the following:

[10]

- (i) You recently took part in a music competition. Write a letter to your grandfather describing your preparation, the performance, and how you felt afterwards.
- (ii) You want to start a 'Self-Defence Club' in your school. Write a letter to the Principal of your school, seeking her permission for the same. Mention the objectives of the club, and explain the ways in which it would be beneficial to the students.

## Question 3

- (i) Your school is hosting an Inter-School Swimming Competition. Write a notice informing the students about the event. [5]
- (ii) Write an e-mail to the Principal of a neighbouring school inviting him/her to send a team to participate. [5]

## Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

My grandmother sat on a string bed under the mango tree, knitting a woollen scarf. It was late summer, and a warm wind moved through the trees. She was very old, dressed in a plain white sari, but her fingers moved quickly with the needles.

I had returned from playing cricket and was **rummaging** through a box of old

books and family things. Most of it did not interest me until I found a small, faded photograph inside a book. It showed a girl standing against a wall. Behind the wall was only the sky, and from the other side, a pair of hands seemed to be reaching up, as if someone were about to climb over. There were flowers growing near the girl and a creeper along the wall.

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I ran to the garden. “Granny! Look at this picture! Whose is it?”

I jumped onto her bed. She scolded me mildly, “Now I’ve lost count of my stitches. Next time, I’ll make you finish the scarf yourself.”

“Whose picture is it?” I asked again.

She took the photograph and *studied* it for a long time. The girl had long hair, wore a long dress, and had bangles on her hands. She stood confidently, with a wide smile.

“A little girl’s, of course,” said Grandmother.

“Yes, but did you know her?”

“I knew her,” she replied, “but she was a very wicked girl. I shouldn’t tell you about her. The photograph was taken in your grandfather’s house about sixty years ago.”

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“Whose hands are those?” I asked, pointing at the picture.

She looked closely. “It’s the first time I’ve noticed them. Perhaps the sweeper boy’s. Or maybe your grandfather’s.”

“They don’t look like Grandfather’s hands,” I said.

“Well, this was sixty years ago,” she replied.

She continued, “I remember what is not in the photograph. It was spring, with a cool breeze. Those flowers were marigolds, and the creeper was full of purple bougainvillea. You cannot see or feel these things in a photograph.”

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“And the girl?” I asked eagerly.

“She was a wicked girl,” said Granny. “She hardly wore proper clothes. She swam in muddy water, played with rough boys, and even rode on buffaloes. No one teased her because she could fight back.”

“She looks like it,” I said. “Something must have happened.”

“Something did happen,” said Granny, smiling. “Her mother wouldn’t let her change after swimming, so she had to stay in those clothes.”

We both laughed. Then I asked, “Who was the girl?”

I looked at her carefully, comparing her with the girl in the photograph. A butterfly settled on her knitting needle, and the afternoon grew quiet.

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“I wonder whose hands they were,” she murmured softly.

*[The Photograph – Ruskin Bond]*

- (i) For each word given below, choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage) from the options provided: [2]

1. rummaging (line 5)

- (a) hiding
- (b) searching
- (c) keeping
- (d) clearing

2. studied (line 15)

- (a) observed
- (b) memorised
- (c) learned
- (d) practised

- (ii) Which word in the passage means the opposite of the word ‘hesitantly’? [1]
- (a) mildly
  - (b) confidently
  - (c) closely
  - (d) softly
- (iii) Answer the following questions briefly in your own words:
- (a) Which sentence in the passage clearly shows that the narrator found only one item in the box worth his attention? [2]
  - (b) Why did Grandmother scold the narrator when he jumped onto her bed? [2]
  - (c) What do Grandmother’s memories of the flowers, breeze, and colours tell us about the limitations of a photograph? [2]
  - (d) Why does Grandmother call the girl ‘wicked’? [2]
  - (e) How would you have reacted if you had realised that the girl in the photograph was your grandmother? [1]
- (iv) In not more than 50 words, describe the photograph and the girl [as seen] in it. [8]

### Question 5

- (i) Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. [4]

**Example:**

*Rohan was waiting at the station. The train (0) \_\_\_\_\_ (not arrive) yet, and the platform was almost empty.*

*Answer: (0) had not arrived*

He began to feel anxious because it was (1) \_\_\_\_\_ (grow) dark and no announcements (2) \_\_\_\_\_ (make). Suddenly, a loud whistle (3) \_\_\_\_\_ (echo) through the air and the headlights of the (4) \_\_\_\_\_ (approach) train appeared at a distance. Rohan sighed with relief. He picked up his small bag and (5) \_\_\_\_\_ (move) closer to the edge of the platform. Just then, a porter (6) \_\_\_\_\_ (rush) past him, (7) \_\_\_\_\_ (shout) for people to stand back. The train pulled in slowly, its windows (8) \_\_\_\_\_ (glow) faintly under the dim lights.

- (ii) Fill in the blanks with appropriate words. [4]
- (a) She is proud \_\_\_\_\_ her younger brother's achievements.
  - (b) He spoke to the audience \_\_\_\_\_ confidence and sincerity.
  - (c) She divided the chocolates equally \_\_\_\_\_ her cousins.
  - (d) The waves crashed violently \_\_\_\_\_ the rocks during the storm.
  - (e) The boy swam \_\_\_\_\_ the river to reach the opposite bank.
  - (f) The little girl peeped \_\_\_\_\_ the keyhole to see what was happening inside.
  - (g) She has been absent \_\_\_\_\_ school since Monday.
  - (h) She completed the project \_\_\_\_\_ her own without any help.

(iii) Choose the correct option to make one complete sentence **without using and, but or so.** [4]

1. She heard the news. She burst into tears.
  - (a) Hearing the news, she burst into tears.
  - (b) She bursted into tears when she heard the news.
  - (c) She burst into tears after hearing the news.
  - (d) Having burst into tears, she heard the news.
2. The road was blocked. There was an accident.
  - (a) There was accident, the road was blocked.
  - (b) The road was blocked because there was an accident.
  - (c) The road was blocked after one accident.
  - (d) Being blocked, there was an accident on the road.
3. The rain was heavy. The match continued without interruption.
  - (a) The match continued without interruption because the rain was heavy.
  - (b) Despite the heavy rain, the match continues without interruption.
  - (c) Despite of heavy rain, the match continued without interruption.
  - (d) Although the rain was heavy, the match continued without interruption.
4. He entered the room. The phone rang.
  - (a) Hardly did he enter the room then the phone rang.
  - (b) Hardly he entered the room when the phone rang.
  - (c) Hardly had he entered the room when the phone rang.
  - (d) Hardly when he entered the room, the phone rang.



- (iv) Choose the correct option and rewrite the sentence according to the instruction given after each. [8]

1. The book was more interesting than the movie.

*(Begin: The movie...)*

- (a) The movie was not as interesting as the book.
- (b) The movie was as interesting as the book.
- (c) The movie was more interesting than the book.
- (d) The movie was the most interesting.

2. I finished my homework and my friend arrived.

*(Begin: No sooner...)*

- (a) No sooner had I finished my homework than my friend arrived.
- (b) No sooner I finished my homework when my friend arrived.
- (c) No sooner did I finish my homework then my friend arrived.
- (d) No sooner had my friend arrived than I finished my homework.

3. The boy is too weak to run fast.

*(Use: so...that)*

- (a) The boy is weak so that he cannot run fast.
- (b) The boy was so weak that he can't run fast.
- (c) The boy is so weak and he cannot run that fast.
- (d) The boy is so weak that he cannot run fast.

4. He will lose his job if he is not punctual.  
(*Begin: Unless...*)
- (a) Unless he was punctual, he would lose his job.
  - (b) Unless he is not punctual, he loses his job.
  - (c) Unless he is punctual, he will lose his job.
  - (d) Unless he being punctual, he will lose his job.
5. I dislike people who are dishonest.  
(*Use: honesty*)
- (a) I dislike people for their honesty.
  - (b) I dislike people who lack honesty.
  - (c) I dislike no honesty people.
  - (d) I dislike people with honesty.
6. Mother said to me, "Finish your homework."  
(*Begin: Mother told...*)
- (a) Mother told me finish your homework.
  - (b) Mother told me to finish my homework.
  - (c) Mother told to finish my homework.
  - (d) Mother told to me to finish my homework.

7. You must hurry or you will miss the bus.

*(Begin: If...)*

(a) If you did not hurry, you will miss the bus.

(b) If you hurry, you will miss the bus.

(c) If you do not hurry, you will miss the bus.

(d) If you hurried, you would miss the bus.

8. He saw the opportunity and grabbed it immediately.

*(Use: Seeing...)*

(a) Seeing the opportunity, grabbed it immediately.

(b) Seeing opportunity, he grabbed it immediately.

(c) He seeing the opportunity grabbed immediately.

(d) Seeing the opportunity, he grabbed it immediately.